

— PRE-SEED · \$1M · 2026

The Crypto Lending Platform That *Explains Itself*.

Crypto-collateralized lending infrastructure for credit unions — with
AI-powered underwriting guidance built in.

140M

CU MEMBERS IN
THE US

\$2.2T

CU ASSETS
UNDER
MANAGEMENT

\$0

B2B CRYPTO
LENDING
INFRASTRUCTURE

— 01 • PROBLEM

Credit unions are *locked out* of crypto lending.

140 million Americans trust their credit union over any bank. But when those members want to unlock liquidity from their Bitcoin or Ethereum, they're forced to D2C lenders like Nexo or Ledn — or to sell, triggering a taxable event.

Credit unions want to serve these members. The regulatory complexity is the barrier — not the appetite.

- 01 No compliant crypto lending infrastructure exists for NCUA-regulated institutions.
- 02 D2C competitors (Nexo, Ledn, SALT) compete with credit unions — they don't serve them.
- 03 Younger members with crypto are migrating to fintech — credit unions are losing them.
- 04 No risk assessment model purpose-built for crypto collateral under NCUA guidelines.
- 05 Custody, connectivity, and KYC/AML integration takes months of compliance work per institution.

The *full stack* a credit union needs to go live.

01 · LENDING ENGINE

Crypto-Collateralized Loans

Members keep their BTC/ETH exposure, avoid the taxable sale, and receive USD liquidity at 8-12% APR. Real-time LTV monitoring with automated margin calls.

02 · RISK

DACS™ Risk Assessment

A patent-pending, multi-pillar risk assessment model purpose-built for crypto collateral. AI guidance layer live — members get plain-language borrowing insights from their DACS profile.

PATENT PENDING

03 · CUSTODY

Institutional Custody

Each credit union holds its own direct institutional custody account. Member wallets live within the CU's structure. Aetherum is the software layer only — we never touch member assets.

04 · COMPLIANCE

Compliance Infrastructure

Bank-grade financial data connectivity approved and live across 6 core products. KYC/AML and fraud infrastructure fully executed — production-ready and live.

05 · COMPLIANCE

ERC-3643 On-Chain Identity

Clean-room implementation of three ERC-3643 modules — jurisdiction gating, collateral LTV verification, CU member identity attestation. Built on T-REX, deployed on Sepolia.

PATENT PENDING

06 · COMPLIANCE

ERC-7943 Collateral Token

The first crypto collateral token built to the official Ethereum RWA standard. Every compliance check runs on-chain and is publicly verifiable. No black boxes, no trust-me architecture.

PATENT PENDING

02 · SOLUTION (cont.)

07 · PRIVACY

Privacy-Preserving Underwriting

Member financial data is encrypted before risk assessment begins. Decisions computed without exposing raw inputs at any step (FHE-DACS).

PATENT PENDING

08 · YIELD

Staking Module

Members stake supported assets through the platform — earning yield while maintaining collateral eligibility. A new revenue stream for CU partners. Coming soon.

09 · TAX INTELLIGENCE

Tax-Position Score & Optimizer (TPSOE™)

Ranks pledge assets by embedded tax liability so the optimal pledge set is always selected. Members borrow smarter, not just more. No B2B competitor offers this.

PATENT PENDING

10 · MEMBER INTELLIGENCE

Member Crypto Insights

Real-time visibility into the assets members already own — before they need a loan. Consent-based wallet connections and an opt-in qualified-borrower pipeline.

PATENT PENDING

11 · COLLATERAL SURVEILLANCE

Collateral Intelligence Engine (CIE™)

Every position monitored 24/7. Finality-aware on-chain event processing, live LTV in basis points, DACS updated on every price move, institution-authorized liquidation.

PATENT PENDING

12 · REGULATORY

NCUA Examiner View

Read-only audit dashboard scoped per credit union. Live on-chain positions, LTV ratios, liquidation events, and a full BSA/AML audit trail. Built for examination from day one.

13 · SETTLEMENT

Multi-Rail Stablecoin Disbursement

Pluggable multi-rail disbursement supporting USD and SGD across EVM-compatible networks — wired end-to-end into the loan origination and settlement pipeline.

The *largest untapped* lending opportunity in credit union history.

"Credit unions are sitting on the largest untapped lending opportunity in their history. Aetherum is the infrastructure layer that makes it accessible."

TAM • TOTAL ADDRESSABLE MARKET

\$150B+

Untapped Crypto Lending Gap. 56M Americans hold crypto. Less than 1% can borrow against it through a regulated institution.

SAM • SERVICEABLE MARKET

\$15–25B

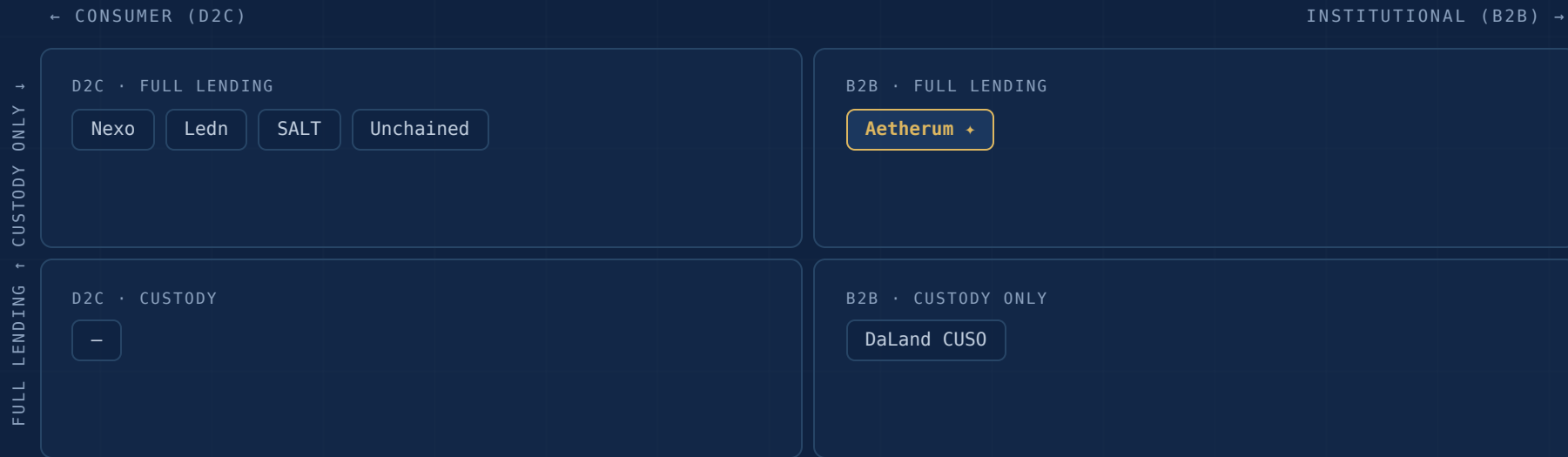
NCUA-Regulated Credit Unions. 4,800 CUs, 140M members, ~21M holding crypto — with no compliant path to liquidity.

SOM • 3-YEAR RAMP

\$1.2M → \$36M

ARR. Yr 1: 10 CUs × 100 loans/mo. Yr 2: 50 CUs × 150. Yr 3: 150 CUs × 200 = \$36M ARR.

Built for institutions. *No one else is.*



"Every competitor is building faster pipes. Aetherum is building the first crypto lending platform purpose-built for regulated institutions — with the compliance infrastructure to match."

DEFENSIBILITY · FOUR MOAT PILLARS

01 · MOAT

DACS™

Patent-pending multi-pillar risk assessment model. No competitor has a purpose-built crypto risk assessment model for NCUA-regulated institutions.

02 · MOAT

Channel

Board advisor Steve Salzer, SVP at Velera — the credit union technology backbone serving 1,400+ institutions. Channel access that cannot be replicated.

03 · MOAT

IP

15 provisional patent applications covering every core system — risk assessment, identity, tax intelligence, privacy-preserving underwriting, collateral management, on-chain compliance.

04 · MOAT · NEW

Audit-Native

Every decision cryptographically anchored on-chain. NCUA examiners get a verification URL, not a promise. No competitor — DaLand, Nexo, Ledn, Unchained — can say this.

Most fintech shows you a dashboard. *Aetherum shows you the reasoning.*



DACS™ Risk Gauge · Smart Review™ · Loan Officer Portal — every loan comes with an explanation the member can read, and a record the examiner wants to see.

Built to the *compliance bar* that keeps others out.

BANK CONNECTIVITY	Financial data connectivity (CRA bundle) approved and live — 6 core products active.	LIVE
COMPLIANCE LAYER	KYC/AML & fraud integration — MSA executed, production-ready compliance infrastructure.	LIVE
3 CORE SYSTEMS	Jack Henry FIN contract executed (Banno live in Garden sandbox). Corelation KeyStone certified. Fiserv AppMarket in progress.	LIVE
CUSTODY	Enterprise custody live — each CU holds its own direct account. Non-custodial by architecture.	LIVE
LIQUIDATION	Three-tier liquidation escalation with human oversight for every large position. Full audit trail.	LIVE
STABLECOIN SETTLEMENT	Multi-rail disbursement live in production — USD & SGD across EVM networks; cross-chain transfer + programmable wallets operational.	LIVE
RIPPLE / XRPL	XLS-66 LoanBroker live on testnet — dual-signature LoanSet flow operational. RLUSD as native loan currency.	LIVE ON TESTNET
ARC · CIRCLE	AetherumCollateralEscrow deployed to Circle's Arc Testnet. Mainnet Q3 2026.	LIVE
PHAROS	USDC + CCTP integration live on Pharos Atlantic Testnet.	LIVE
NATIVE LTV MONITOR	BTC/ETH collateral polled every 60 seconds — 30-day rolling volatility feeds DACS. No third-party dependency.	LIVE
PLATFORM	Full-stack MVP live at test-app.aetherum.ai. ERC-3643 modules deployed on Sepolia.	LIVE

DACS™	Ten-pillar risk assessment model , live gauge wired to API.	PATENT PENDING
TPSOE™	Tax-Position Score & Collateral Optimizer ranks pledge assets by embedded tax liability. No B2B competitor offers this.	PATENT PENDING
FHE-DACS	Homomorphic encryption layer — member data stays encrypted throughout underwriting.	PATENT PENDING
CIE™	Real-time collateral surveillance pipeline live in production.	PATENT PENDING
ERC-3643 / 7943	Only on-chain compliance layer purpose-built for CU lending. Deployed and verified on Sepolia (T-REX standard).	LIVE ON TESTNET
COMPLIANCE RECEIPTS	On-chain compliance receipt system live on Sepolia. SHA-256 commitment per lending decision; examiners get a verification URL.	AETHERUM-012
DACS EXPLAINABILITY	Examiner-grade underwriting records with factor-level breakdowns & 12 CFR Part 723 citation. PDF export for NCUA submission.	AETHERUM-013
SUPERVISORY CONTROL	NCUA-aligned supervisory hold system with on-chain attestation and CSV examination export.	AETHERUM-014
DDQ ENGINE	342-entry security questionnaire (full SIG framework). A CU's risk team can complete a full vendor security review without a call. Live at aetherum.ai/ddq .	LIVE
SMART REVIEW	AI-powered underwriting guidance live in production — zero added friction in the loan flow.	LIVE
ECOSYSTEM ADVISOR	Steve Salzer, SVP at Velera — Board Advisor. NACUSO Regulatory Advocacy Committee & CUNA Payments Subcommittee.	ACTIVE
IP / PATENTS	15 provisional patent applications filed with the USPTO across the full platform.	15 PATENTS PENDING

Five streams. *Platform-fee led.*

ARR TARGET

\$1K/loan × 100 loans/mo × 10 CUs = \$1.2M ARR

70%

Platform Fees

\$500–\$1,500 per loan originated. Primary revenue driver, tied to volume.

20%

Transaction Fees

0.5–1% on crypto collateral transactions processed through the platform.

10%

SaaS License

\$50K–\$150K/year for large credit unions. Predictable ARR layer at scale.

New

Tax Intelligence Module

\$10K–\$25K/year per CU as a premium add-on. No B2B competitor offers this to institutions.

New

ERC-3643 + ERC-7943 Compliance Layer

Per-attestation module licensing. Any RWA issuer requiring US jurisdiction or CU member identity verification licenses our modules.

Built by operators. *Advised by the ecosystem.*

John Bailey

FOUNDER & CEO

20+ years in technical recruiting with placements at Google, Spotify, and Goldman Sachs. Previously co-founded Thorium Data. Building Aetherum full-time since early 2025 — product, BD, fundraising, and technical implementation.

Steve Salzer

BOARD ADVISOR • SVP, VELERA

SVP at Velera since 2017. Chairs the Board of Managers at Ongoing Operations LLC. NACUSO Regulatory Advocacy Committee and CUNA Payments Subcommittee. JD, University of Chicago Law School.

Rahul Goel

ADVISOR • JP MORGAN / UBER

Cybersecurity and financial infrastructure expertise from senior roles at JP Morgan and Uber, including involvement with Meta's Novi digital wallet. Advises on platform security and institutional trust.

Saiprasad Raut

ADVISOR • WORLDPAY / VANAR

Head of Payments Infrastructure at Vanar, formerly Worldpay. Deep payments and blockchain infrastructure expertise guiding settlement and custody architecture.

— 09 • THE ASK

Closing a *\$1M Pre-Seed* Round.

We're in the final stretch of closing our pre-seed round. Proceeds go toward closing the first two credit union pilots, completing platform development, and bringing on a CTO. Capital deploys us to the first 3 credit union pilots — reducing market risk and proving the explanation layer at scale.

ROUND SIZE	\$1,000,000
INSTRUMENT	Post-Money SAFE
VALUATION CAP	\$8M Post-Money
DISCOUNT	20%
TIMELINE	Closing Soon

— REQUEST A DEMO

Let's talk.

20 minutes. We'll walk through the platform live and answer any diligence questions.

BOOK A CALL

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